

Book

Hardness of the heart

Causes and treatment

Collected, compiled and presented (mentioning the legal evidence from the Qur'an, Sunnah, and the valid references) by

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كتاب قسوة القلوب أسباب وعلاج

الجمع والتأليف والتقديم مع ذكر الأدلة الشرعية من الكتاب والسنة والمراجع
الصحيحة

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Introduction

All praise is due to Allah, Whom we praise and seek help, guidance and forgiveness from. We seek refuge with Allah from the evils within ourselves and from the burden of our evil deeds. He whom Allah guides, will never be misled; and he whom He misguides, will never have one who will guide him.

And I bear witness that there is no god but Allah, the Protector of the righteous, and I bear witness that our Prophet Muhammad is His servant and messenger.

“O believers! Be mindful of Allah in the way He deserves, and do not die except in ‘a state of full’ submission ‘to Him’.” (Ali-Imran: 102)

“O humanity! Be mindful of your Lord Who created you from a single soul, and from it He created its mate, and through both He spread countless men and women. And be mindful of Allah—in Whose Name you appeal to one another—and ‘honour’ family ties. Surely Allah is ever Watchful over you.” (An-Nisaa: 1)

“O believers! Be mindful of Allah, and say what is right. He will bless your deeds for you, and forgive your sins. And whoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, has truly achieved a great triumph.” (Al-Ahzab:70-71)

To proceed:

The best of the speech is embodied in the Book of Allah, and the best of the guidance is the guidance given by Muhammad. And the evillest affairs are their innovations; and every innovation is misguidance.

مقدمة المؤلف

إِنَّ الْحَمْدَ لِلَّهِ نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُسْتَعِينُهُ وَنَسْتَغْفِرُهُ، وَنَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنْ شُرُورِ
أَنْفُسِنَا وَمِنْ سَيِّئَاتِ أَعْمَالِنَا، مَنْ يَهْدِهِ اللَّهُ فَلَا مُضِلَّ لَهُ، وَمَنْ
يُضِلِّهِ فَلَا هَادِيَ لَهُ.
وَأَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَحْدَهُ لَا شَرِيكَ لَهُ، وَأَشْهَدُ أَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا
عَبْدُهُ وَرَسُولُهُ.

**{يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ حَقَّ تُقَاتِهِ وَلَا تَمُوتُنَّ إِلَّا وَأَنْتُمْ
مُسْلِمُونَ} (آل عمران: 102)**

**{يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اتَّقُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ وَخَلَقَ
مِنْهَا زَوْجَهَا وَبَثَّ مِنْهُمَا رِجَالًا كَثِيرًا وَنِسَاءً وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ الَّذِي
تَسَاءَلُونَ بِهِ وَالْأَرْحَامَ إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَانَ عَلَيْكُمْ رَقِيبًا} (النساء: 1)**

**{يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ وَقُولُوا قَوْلًا سَدِيدًا * يُصْلِحْ لَكُمْ
أَعْمَالَكُمْ وَيَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ ذُنُوبَكُمْ وَمَنْ يُطِيعِ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ فَقَدْ فَازَ فَوْزًا
عَظِيمًا} (الأحزاب: 70، 71)**

أَمَّا بَعْدُ:

فَإِنَّ خَيْرَ الْحَدِيثِ كِتَابُ اللَّهِ، وَخَيْرُ الْهَدْيِ هَدْيُ مُحَمَّدٍ صَلَّى اللَّهُ
عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ، وَشَرُّ الْأُمُورِ مُحَدَّثَاتُهَا، وَكُلُّ بِدْعَةٍ ضَلَالَةٌ.

To proceed:

Verily, Allah did not create His creation without purpose, but rather he gave them the heart, the hearing, the sight, and limbs, as a blessing and favour from him, so that they might worship Him and held belief in the unity of him.

Allah Almighty said: **"Did you then think that We had created you without purpose, and that you would never be returned to Us?"** (Al Mu'menun: 115)

All happiness in this world and the hereafter is for whoever uses that in the obedience to Allah.

Misery and sadness are for the one who uses Allah's blessings to disobey him.

The heart is the king of the limbs. If the heart is sound, the limbs are sound. If the heart is corrupt, the limbs are corrupt. So, all limbs are subject to its obedience. The limbs gain from heart the steadfastness or deviation. Allah's Messenger said: **"In the body there is a piece of flesh, and the whole body is sound if it is sound, but the whole body is corrupt if it is corrupt. It is the heart."**

Therefore, when the enemy of Allah, Satan, knew that the focus and reliance are on the heart; He whispered him with the insinuations, came with the bad desires to him, and beautified for him in words and deeds what would repel him from the path of Allah Almighty.

أَمَّا بَعْدُ:

فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ لَمْ يَخْلُقْ خَلْقَهُ سُوءَى، بَلْ أَعْطَاهُمْ الْقَلْبَ وَالسَّمْعَ،
وَالْبَصَرَ، وَالْجَوَارِحَ، نِعْمَةً مِنْهُ وَتَفَضُّلاً، لِيَعْبُدُوهُ وَيُوحِّدُوهُ.

قَالَ تَعَالَى: **"أَفَحَسِبْتُمْ أَنَّمَا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ عَبَثًا وَأَنَّكُمْ إِلَيْنَا لَا**

تَرْجِعُونَ" (المؤمنون: 115)

فَالسَّعَادَةُ كُلُّ السَّعَادَةِ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ لِمَنْ اسْتَعْمَلَ ذَلِكَ فِي
طَاعَةِ اللَّهِ.

وَالشَّقَاءُ وَالْحُزْنُ لِكُلِّ مَنْ اسْتَعْمَلَ نِعَمَ اللَّهِ فِي مَعْصِيَتِهِ.

وَالْقَلْبُ هُوَ مَلِكُ الْأَعْضَاءِ، فَإِنْ صَلَحَ الْقَلْبُ صَلَحَتِ الْجَوَارِحُ،
وإِنْ فَسَدَ الْقَلْبُ فَسَدَتِ الْجَوَارِحُ، فَكُلُّ الْجَوَارِحِ تَحْتَ طَاعَتِهِ،
تَكْتَسِبُ مِنْهُ الْإِسْتِقَامَةَ أَوْ الزَّيْغَ، قَالَ النَّبِيُّ (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ
وَسَلَّمَ) **"أَلَا وَإِنَّ فِي الْجَسَدِ مُضْغَةً إِذَا صَلَحَتْ صَلَحَ الْجَسَدُ كُلُّهُ
وَإِذَا فَسَدَتْ فَسَدَ الْجَسَدُ كُلُّهُ أَلَا وَهِيَ الْقَلْبُ"**

وَلِذَلِكَ لَمَّا عَلِمَ عَدُوُّ اللَّهِ إِبْلِيسُ أَنَّ الْمَدَارَ عَلَى الْقَلْبِ وَالْإِعْتِمَادَ
عَلَيْهِ؛ أَجْلَبَ عَلَيْهِ بِالْوَسَاوِسِ، وَأَقْبَلَ بِوُجُوهِ الشَّهَوَاتِ إِلَيْهِ، وَزَيَّنَ
لَهُ مِنَ الْأَقْوَالِ وَالْأَعْمَالِ مَا يَصُدُّهُ بِهِ عَنِ طَرِيقِ اللَّهِ تَعَالَى.

There is no escape from Satan except by seeking help from Allah Almighty, persevering in what pleases Allah Almighty, and being addicted to the remembrance of Allah Almighty, for remembrance of Allah Almighty is like a strong fortress on the heart. Satan will never be able to enter this heart. Allah Almighty said to Satan: **“You will truly have no authority over My ‘faithful’ servants.”** (Al-Israa:65).

And know that the origin of the corrupted deed is the corruption of heart, and that the origin of the righteous deed is the righteous heart. For that, Allah Almighty said: **“the Day when neither wealth nor children will be of any benefit. Only those who come before Allah with a pure heart ‘will be saved’.”** (Ash-Shuraa: 88-89)

This message - although small - addresses this serious matter, which is the hardness of hearts, and mentions its causes.

In this message, I have relied on what the nation’s great scholars have said, and whoever looking for more should refer to the following books.

Imam Al-Kharaiti's book: (Disease of the hearts), which is in two volumes.

And Imam Abu Hamid Al-Ghazali's book: (Reviving the Sciences of Religion).

وَلَا نَجَاةَ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ إِلَّا بِالْإِسْتِعَاةِ بِاللَّهِ تَعَالَى، وَالْمُوَاطَّاةِ عَلَى مَا يُرْضِي اللَّهَ تَعَالَى، وَإِذْمَانِ ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ تَعَالَى، فَذَكَرَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى كَالْحِصْنِ الشَّدِيدِ عَلَى الْقَلْبِ، وَلَنْ يَسْتَطِيعَ الشَّيْطَانُ أَنْ يَدْخُلَ إِلَى قَلْبِهِ أَبَدًا، قَالَ تَعَالَى لِلشَّيْطَانِ: **"إِنَّ عِبَادِي لَيْسَ لَكَ عَلَيْهِمْ سُلْطَانٌ"** (الإسراء: 65).

وَاعْلَمْ أَنَّ الْعَمَلَ الْفَاسِدَ أَضْلُهُ فَسَادُ الْقَلْبِ، وَالْعَمَلَ الصَّالِحَ أَضْلُهُ صَلاَحُ الْقَلْبِ وَلِذَلِكَ قَالَ تَعَالَى: **"يَوْمَ لَا يَنْفَعُ مَالٌ وَلَا بَنُونَ . إِلَّا مَنْ أَتَى اللَّهَ بِقَلْبٍ سَلِيمٍ"** (الشعراء: 88- 89).

وَهَذِهِ الرِّسَالَةُ -عَلَى صِغَرِهَا- إِلَّا أَنَّهَا تُعَالِجُ هَذَا الْأَمْرَ الْخَطِيرَ وَهُوَ قَسْوَةُ الْقُلُوبِ وَذِكْرُ أَسْبَابِهَا.

وَقَدْ اعْتَمَدْتُ فِي هَذِهِ الرِّسَالَةِ عَلَى مَا قَالَهُ عُلَمَاءُ الْأُمَّةِ الْكِبَارِ، وَمَنْ أَرَادَ الْمَزِيدَ فَلْيَرْجِعْ إِلَى الْكُتُبِ النَّالِيَةِ:
الإمام الخرائطي في كتابه: (اغتيال القلوب) وهو يقع في مجلدين.
والإمام أبو حامد الغزالي في كتابه: (إحياء علوم الدين).

And also, in more than one of the books of scholar Ibn al-Qayyim, such as: (Relief for the Sorrowful), and in most of his book: (The Disease and the Cure) and in some places in (Madarik al-Salikeen) and (Al-Wabil Al-Sayb).

Also, Imam Ibn al-Jawzi said in the opening of his book: (Condemning Inclinations).

And also Ibn Qadamah in his book: (brief of the approach of the strivers).

And (Condemning the Hardness of the Heart) by Ibn Rajab.

This is for those who want more benefit, and we ask Allah to place this message in the balance of our good deeds **“the Day when neither wealth nor children will be of any benefit. Only those who come before Allah with a pure heart ‘will be saved’.”** (Ash-Shuraa: 88-89)

And to benefit us with it and act according to what is in it. We ask Allah to protect us and you from the hardness of the heart and its condemnation. He is the Master and Guardian of that.

May the prayers and blessings of Allah be upon the bearer of glad tidings and the warner, Muhammad, and upon his family and all his companions. And all praise is for Allah, Lord of all worlds.

وَأَيْضًا الْعَلَّامَةُ ابْنُ الْقَيِّمِ فِي أَكْثَرِ مِنْ كِتَابٍ لَهُ مِثْلُ: (إِغَاثَةُ
الْهَلْفَانِ)، وَفِي جُلِّ كِتَابِهِ: (الدَّاءُ وَالِدَوَاءُ) وَبَعْضُ مَوَاطِنَ فِي
(مَدَارِكِ السَّالِكِينَ) وَ (الْوَابِلِ الصَّيْبِ).

وَأَيْضًا الْإِمَامُ ابْنُ الْجَوَازِيِّ فِي فَوَاتِحِ كِتَابِهِ: (ذَمُّ الْهَوَى).
وَأَيْضًا ابْنُ قُدَّامَةَ فِي كِتَابِهِ: (مُخْتَصَرُ مِنْهَاجِ الْقَاصِدِينَ).
وَ (ذَمُّ قَسْوَةِ الْقَلْبِ) لِابْنِ رَجَبٍ.

هَذَا لِمَنْ أَرَادَ الْإِسْتِفَادَةَ، وَنَسْأَلُ اللَّهَ أَنْ يَجْعَلَ هَذِهِ الرِّسَالَةَ فِي
مِيزَانِ حَسَنَاتِنَا "يَوْمَ لَا يَنْفَعُ مَالٌ وَلَا بَنُونَ. إِلَّا مَنْ أَتَى اللَّهَ بِقَلْبٍ
سَلِيمٍ". (الشعراء: 88- 89).

وَأَنْ يَنْفَعَنَا بِهَا، وَالْعَمَلُ بِمَا فِيهَا، وَنَسْأَلُ اللَّهَ أَنْ يُعَافِيَنَا وَإِيَّاكُمْ مِنْ
قَسْوَةِ الْقَلْبِ وَذَمِّهِ، إِنَّهُ وَلِيُّ ذَلِكَ وَمَوْلَاهُ.

وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى الْبَشِيرِ النَّذِيرِ مُحَمَّدٍ، وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَصَحْبِهِ أَجْمَعِينَ،
وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ

Definition of Al-Qaswa (hardness)

It indicates intensity and hardness. It is said a stone is *Qasy* meaning solid.

Imam Al-Qurtubi said: “Al-Qaswa is hardness, sternness and dryness. Allah Almighty said: **“So woe to those whose hearts are hardened.”** (Az-Zumar: 22) So, what is meant is those hard hearts that do not understand good and do not do it.¹

Al-Izz bin Abd al-Salam said: Qaswa is the hardening of the heart and its deviation from following the truth. the tenderness and softness of the heart are otherwise.²

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¹ Tafsir Al-Qurtubi (1-317)

² Tree of Knowledge and Circumstances (120)

تَعْرِيفُ الْقَسْوَةِ

تَدُلُّ عَلَى شِدَّةٍ وَصَلَابَةٍ، وَمِنْ ذَلِكَ الْحَجَرُ الْقَاسِي أَيُّ: الصَّلْبِ.

قَالَ الْإِمَامُ الْقُرْطُبِيُّ: الْقَسْوَةُ هِيَ الصَّلَابَةُ وَالشَّدَّةُ وَالْيَبَسُ، قَالَ تَعَالَى: "فَوَيْلٌ لِلْقَاسِيَةِ قُلُوبُهُمْ" (الزمر: 22)، فَاَلْمُرَادُ تِلْكَ الْقُلُوبُ الصَّلْبَةُ الَّتِي لَا تَعِي خَيْرًا وَلَا تَفْعَلُهُ.¹

وَقَالَ الْعِزُّ بْنُ عَبْدِ السَّلَامِ: الْقَسْوَةُ تَصَلُّبُ الْقَلْبِ وَنَبَوْتُهُ مِنْ اتِّبَاعِ الْحَقِّ، وَرِقَّتِهِ (أَيُّ: الْقَلْبِ) وَلِيْنِهِ بِخِلَافِ ذَلِكَ.²

¹ تفسير القرطبي (1-317)

² شجرة المعارف والأحوال (120)

Verses contained in Qaswa (hardness)

Allah Almighty said: **“This is when a man was killed and you disputed who the killer was, but Allah revealed what you concealed. So We instructed, “Strike the dead body with a piece of the cow.” This is how easily Allah brings the dead to life, showing you His signs so that you may understand. Even then your hearts became hardened like a rock or even harder, for some rocks gush rivers; others split, spilling water; while others are humbled in awe of Allah. And Allah is never unaware of what you do.”** (Al-Baqara: 72-74)

Al-Saadi said in his interpretation, p. 37: **“your hearts became hardened”** meaning: they became hardened and more intense, so the sermon had no effect on it.

“Even then”: i.e. After Allah bestowed upon you great blessings and showed you signs, your hearts should not have been hardened, because what you witnessed is what necessitates tenderness and submission of the heart.

Allah Almighty said: **“Allah made a covenant with the Children of Israel and appointed twelve leaders from among them and then said, “I am truly with you. If you establish prayer, pay alms-tax, believe in My messengers, support them, and lend to Allah a good loan, I will certainly forgive your sins and admit you into Gardens under which rivers flow. And whoever among you disbelieves afterwards has truly strayed from the Right Way.”**

الآيات الواردة في القسوة

قَالَ تَعَالَى: "وَإِذْ قَتَلْتُمْ نَفْسًا فَادَّارَأْتُمْ فِيهَا ۚ وَاللَّهُ مُخْرِجُ مَا كُنْتُمْ تَكْتُمُونَ. فَقُلْنَا اضْرِبُوهُ بِبَعْضِهَا ۚ كَذَلِكَ يُخَيِّ اللَّهُ الْمَوْتَى وَيُرِيكُمْ ءَايَاتِهِ ۚ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَعْقِلُونَ. ثُمَّ قَسَتْ قُلُوبُكُمْ مِّنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ فَهِيَ كَالْحِجَارَةِ أَوْ أَشَدُّ قَسْوَةً ۚ وَإِن مِّنْ الْحِجَارَةِ لَمَا يَتَفَجَّرُ مِنْهُ الْأَنْهَارُ ۚ وَإِن مِّنْهَا لَمَا يَشَقَّقُ فَيَخْرُجُ مِنْهُ الْمَاءُ ۚ وَإِن مِّنْهَا لَمَا يَهْبِطُ مِنْ خَشْيَةِ اللَّهِ ۚ وَمَا اللَّهُ بِغَفِلٍ عَمَّا تَعْمَلُونَ" (البقرة: 74 - 72).

قال السعدي في تفسيره ص 37: "ثُمَّ قَسَتْ قُلُوبُكُمْ" أي: اشتدت وغلظت، فلم تؤثر فيها الموعظة.

"مِّنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ": مِّنْ بَعْدِ أَنْ أَنْعَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْكُمْ بِالنِّعَمِ الْعَظِيمَةِ، وَأَرَاكُمْ الْآيَاتِ، وَلَمْ يَكُنْ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ تَقْسُو قُلُوبَكُمْ، لِأَنَّ مَا شَاهَدْتُمْ مِمَّا يُوْجِبُ رِقَّةَ الْقَلْبِ وَانْقِيَادَهُ.

قَالَ تَعَالَى: "وَلَقَدْ أَخَذَ اللَّهُ مِيثَاقَ بَنِي إِسْرَءِيلَ وَبَعَثْنَا مِنْهُمُ اثْنَيْ عَشَرَ نَقِيبًا ۖ وَقَالَ اللَّهُ إِنِّي مَعَكُمْ ۖ لَئِنْ أَقَمْتُمُ الصَّلَاةَ وَءَاتَيْتُمُ الزَّكَاةَ وَءَامَنْتُمْ بِرُسُلِي وَعَزَّرْتُمُوهُمْ وَأَقْرَضْتُمُ اللَّهَ قَرْضًا حَسَنًا لَّا أَكْفِرَنَّ عَنْكُمْ سَيِّئَاتِكُمْ وَلَأُدْخِلَنَّكُمْ جَنَّاتٍ تَجْرِي مِنْ تَحْتِهَا الْأَنْهَارُ ۚ فَمَن كَفَرَ بَعْدَ ذَلِكَ مِنْكُمْ فَقَدْ ضَلَّ سَوَاءَ السَّبِيلِ."

But for breaking their covenant We condemned them and hardened their hearts. They distorted the words of the Scripture and neglected a portion of what they had been commanded to uphold. You 'O Prophet' will always find deceit on their part, except for a few. But pardon them and bear with them. Indeed, Allah loves the good-doers." (Al-Ma'da: 12-14).

Al-Saadi said in his interpretation, p. 187: **"and hardened their hearts."** i.e. hard in which sermons are of no use and signs and light are of no benefit to them. They are not desired by suspense, nor are they disturbed by fear. This is one of the greatest punishments for the servant, for his heart to have this quality, with which neither guidance nor goodness benefits him except with evil.

Allah Almighty said: **"Indeed, We have sent messengers before you 'O Prophet' to other people who We put through suffering and adversity 'for their denial', so perhaps they would be humbled. Why did they not humble themselves when We made them suffer? Instead, their hearts were hardened, and Satan made their misdeeds appealing to them."** (Al-Anaam: 42-43).

Al-Qurtubi said in his interpretation (6/333): **"Instead, their hearts were hardened"**: i.e.: hardened and became harsh. It is an expression of disbelief and insistence on sin. We ask Allah to protect us.

"and Satan made their misdeeds appealing to them": i.e., he tempted and pushed them to commit sins.

فَبِمَا نَقْضِهِمْ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَجَعَلْنَا قُلُوبَهُمْ قَاسِيَةً يُحَرِّفُونَ
الْكَلِمَ عَنْ مَوَاضِعِهِ ۚ وَنَسُوا حَظًّا مِمَّا ذُكِّرُوا بِهِ ۚ وَلَا تَزَالُ
تَطَّلُعُ عَلَى خَائِنَةٍ مِّنْهُمْ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا مِّنْهُمْ ۚ فَاعْفُ عَنْهُمْ وَاصْفَحْ ۚ
إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُحِبُّ الْمُحْسِنِينَ" (المائدة: 14-12).

قال السعدي في تفسيره ص 187: "**وَجَعَلْنَا قُلُوبَهُمْ قَاسِيَةً**"
أي: غليظة لا تجدي فيها المواعظ ولا تنفعها الآيات والنور،
فلا يرغبهم تشويق، ولا يزعجهم تخويف، وهذا من أعظم
العقوبات على العبد، أن يكون قلبه بهذه الصفة، التي
لا يفيده معها الهدى ولا الخير إلا شرا.

قَالَ تَعَالَى: "**وَلَقَدْ أَرْسَلْنَا إِلَى أُمَمٍ مِّن قَبْلِكَ فَأَخَذْنَاهُمْ
بِالْبَاسَاءِ وَالْضُرَّاءِ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَتَضَرَّعُونَ. فَلَوْلَا إِذْ جَاءَهُمْ
بَأْسُنَا تَضَرَّعُوا وَلَكِن قَسَتْ قُلُوبُهُمْ وَزَيَّنَ لَهُمُ الشَّيْطَانُ
مَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ**" (الأنعام: 42-43).

قال القرطبي في تفسيره (6/333): "**وَلَكِن قَسَتْ
قُلُوبُهُمْ**" أي صلبت وغلظت، هي عبارة عن الكفر والإصرار
على المعصية نسأل الله العافية.

"**وَزَيَّنَ لَهُمُ الشَّيْطَانُ مَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ**" أي أغواهم
بالمعاصي وحملهم عليها.

Allah Almighty said: **“Can ‘the misguided be like’ those whose hearts Allah has opened to Islam, so they are enlightened by their Lord? So woe to those whose hearts are hardened at the remembrance of Allah! It is they who are clearly astray.”** (Az-Zumr: 22)¹.

Al-Tabari said in his interpretation (23/248): **“So woe to those whose hearts are hardened at the remembrance of Allah!”**

Allah’s saying: Woe to those whose hearts have dried up and turned away from the remembrance of Allah i.e.: the Qur’an which Allah the Almighty revealed, reminding His servants of it, but they do not believe in it or in what is in it.

His Saying: **“It is they who are clearly astray.”**: i.e. These people are from mentioning Allah in clear astray.

¹ See Tafsir al-Saadi, p. 668

قَالَ تَعَالَى: "أَفَمَنْ شَرَحَ اللَّهُ صَدْرَهُ لِلْإِسْلَامِ فَهُوَ عَلَى
نُورٍ مِّن رَّبِّهِ ۖ فَوَيْلٌ لِّلْقَاسِيَةِ قُلُوبُهُم مِّن ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ ۖ
أُولَٰئِكَ فِي ضَلَالٍ مُّبِينٍ" (الزمر: 22).¹

قَالَ الطَّبْرِي فِي تَفْسِيرِهِ (248 / 23): قَوْلُهُ "فَوَيْلٌ لِّلْقَاسِيَةِ
قُلُوبُهُم مِّن ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ" يَقُولُ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى ذِكْرُهُ: فَوَيْلٌ لِّلَّذِينَ
جَفَّتْ قُلُوبُهُمْ وَنَأَتْ عَن ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ وَأَعْرَضَتْ، يَعْنِي الْقُرْآنَ
الَّذِي أَنْزَلَهُ تَعَالَى مُذَكِّرًا بِهِ عِبَادَهُ، فَلَمْ يُؤْمِنُوا بِهِ، وَلَا بِمَا
فِيهِ.

قَوْلُهُ "أُولَٰئِكَ فِي ضَلَالٍ مُّبِينٍ" أَي: هَؤُلَاءِ مَن ذَكَرَ اللَّهَ فِي
ضَلَالٍ مُّبِينٍ.

انظر تفسر السعدي ص 668 ¹

Hadiths about Qaswa (hardness)

Narrated Ata bin Yasar:

I met `Abdullah bin `Amr bin Al-`As and asked him, "Tell (ﷺ) me about the description of Allah's Messenger which is mentioned in Torah (i.e. Old Testament.)" He replied, 'Yes. By Allah, he is described in Torah with some of the qualities attributed to him in the Qur'an as follows: **"O Prophet! We have sent you as a witness (for Allah's True religion) And a giver of glad tidings (to the faithful believers), And a warner (to the unbelievers)** (Al-Ahzab:45). And guardian of the illiterates. You are My slave and My messenger. I have named you "Al-Mutawakkil" (who depends upon Allah). You are neither discourteous, harsh nor a noisemaker in the markets and you do not do evil to those Who do evil to you, but you deal With them with forgiveness and kindness. Allah will not let him (the Prophet) Die till he makes straight the crooked people by making them say: "None has the right to be worshipped but Allah," With which will be opened blind eyes, deaf ears and enveloped hearts"¹

¹ Sahih al-Bukhari 2125

الْأَحَادِيثُ الْوَارِدَةُ فِي الْقَسْوَةِ

عَنْ عَطَاءِ بْنِ يَسَارٍ، قَالَ لَقِيتُ عَبْدَ اللَّهِ بْنَ عَمْرِو بْنِ الْعَاصِ. رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا. قُلْتُ أَخْبِرْنِي عَنْ صِفَةِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فِي التَّوْرَةِ. قَالَ أَجَلٌ، وَاللَّهِ إِنَّهُ لَمَوْصُوفٌ فِي التَّوْرَةِ بِبَعْضِ صِفَتِهِ فِي الْقُرْآنِ **"يَا أَيُّهَا النَّبِيُّ إِنَّا أَرْسَلْنَاكَ شَاهِدًا وَمُبَشِّرًا وَنَذِيرًا"** (الأحزاب: 45)، وَحِزْرًا لِلْأُمِّيِّينَ، أَنْتَ عَبْدِي وَرَسُولِي سَمَّيْتُكَ الْمُتَوَكَّلَ، لَيْسَ بِفَظٍّ وَلَا غَلِيظٍ وَلَا سَخَّابٍ فِي الْأَسْوَاقِ، وَلَا يَدْفَعُ بِالسَّيِّئَةِ السَّيِّئَةَ وَلَكِنْ يَغْفُو وَيَغْفِرُ، وَلَنْ يَقْبِضَهُ اللَّهُ حَتَّى يُقِيمَ بِهِ الْمِلَّةَ الْعُوجَاءَ بِأَنْ يَقُولُوا لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ. وَيَفْتَحُ بِهَا أَعْيُنًا عُمَيَّا، وَأَذَانًا صُمًّا، وَقُلُوبًا غُلْفًا.¹

أخرجه البخاري 2125¹

Effects of Qaswa (hardness)

1. **Malik bin Dinar said:** “A servant was not struck with punishment more severe than the hardness of the heart.”¹

2. **Yahya bin Muadh said:** “Tears did not dry except because of the hardness of hearts. Hearts did not harden except because of the abundance of sins. Sins did not increase except because of the abundance of faults”.²

¹ Narrated by Ahmad in Al-Zuhd, p. 320

² Narrated by Al-Bayhaqi in Al-Shu'ab 6828

الأثار الواردة في القسوة

1- قَالَ مَالِكُ بْنُ دِينَارٍ: " مَا ضُرِبَ عَبْدٌ بِعُقُوبَةٍ أَعْظَمَ مِنْ قَسْوَةِ الْقَلْبِ ".¹

2- قَالَ يَحْيَى بْنُ مُعَاذٍ: " مَا جَفَّتِ الدُّمُوعُ إِلَّا لَقَسْوَةِ الْقُلُوبِ. وَمَا قَسَتِ الْقُلُوبُ إِلَّا لِكَثْرَةِ الذُّنُوبِ. وَلَا كَثُرَتِ الذُّنُوبُ إِلَّا مِنْ كَثْرَةِ الْعُيُوبِ ".²

¹ أخرجه أحمد في الزهد ص 320

² رواه البيهقي في الشعب 6828

The results of hardness of hearts

1. The hardness of hearts removes gentleness, mercy, and reverence.
2. The person with a hard heart is far from Allah and far from people.
3. The hardness of hearts removes blessings and replaces curses.
4. In rudeness and hard-heartedness with Muslims, which leads to division in their speech and the enemy's greed for them.
5. Rudeness and harshness lead -especially in the field of calling to Allah- people turning away from the preacher and alienating them from him. ¹

¹ Nadarat al-Qulub, p. 5324-5328

نتائج قسوة القلوب

- 1- القسوة تُذهب اللين والرحمة والخشوع.
- 2- صاحب القلب القاسي بعيد من الله وبعيد من الناس.
- 3- القسوة تُزيل النعم وتُحلّ النقم.
- 4- في الفظاظة والغلظة القلب مع المسلمين ما يُؤدّي إلى تفرّق كلمتهم وطمع العدو فيهم.
- 5- الفظاظة والغلظة تُؤديان - خاصةً في مجال الدّعوة إلى الله - إلى انصراف الناس عن الدّاعية، ونفورهم منه.¹

The sound heart

A sound heart is the one which benefits the believer when he meets his Lord **“the Day when neither wealth nor children will be of any benefit. Only those who come before Allah with a pure heart ‘will be saved’.”** (Ash-Shuraa: 88-89)

It is the repentance of the heart that grants its owner Paradise. Allah says: **“And Paradise will be brought near to the righteous, not far off. ‘And it will be said to them,’ ‘This is what you were promised, for whoever ‘constantly’ turned ‘to Allah’ and kept up ‘His commandments’ — who were in awe of the Most Compassionate without seeing ‘Him’, and have come with a heart turning ‘only to Him’. Enter it in peace. This is the Day of eternal life! There they will have whatever they desire, and with Us is ‘even’ more.”** (Qaaf: 31- 35)

The integrity of the heart makes the heart free of corrupt beliefs, false doctrines, and inclination toward the desires and pleasures of this world.

It is a heart that has surrendered to God, Lord of the worlds.

A heart that was not swept away by The enjoyment of ‘worldly’ desires—women, children,¹ treasures of gold and silver, fine horses, cattle, and fertile land

A heart that is not distracted by money and children from obeying its Lord and submitting to Him.

A heart that reveres the remembrance of Allah.

الْقَلْبُ السَّلِيم

الْقَلْبُ السَّلِيم هُوَ الَّذِي يَنْفَعُ الْمُؤْمِنَ عِنْدَ لِقَاءِ رَبِّهِ "يَوْمَ لَا يَنْفَعُ مَالٌ وَلَا بَنُونَ. إِلَّا مَنْ أَتَى اللَّهَ بِقَلْبٍ سَلِيمٍ". (الشعراء: 88-89).

وإِنَابَةُ الْقَلْبِ هِيَ الَّتِي تُجْعَلُ لِصَاحِبِهَا الْجَنَّةَ. قَالَ تَعَالَى: "وَأُزْلِفَتِ الْجَنَّةُ لِلْمُتَّقِينَ غَيْرَ بَعِيدٍ. هَذَا مَا تُوعَدُونَ لِكُلِّ أَوَّابٍ حَفِيفٍ. مَنْ خَشِيَ الرَّحْمَنَ الْغَيْبَ وَجَاءَ بِقَلْبٍ مُنِيبٍ. ادْخُلُوهَا بِسَلَامٍ" ذَلِكَ يَوْمُ الْخُلُودِ. لَهُمْ مَا يَشَاءُونَ فِيهَا وَلَدَيْنَا مَزِيدٌ" (ق: 31 - 35)

فَسَلَامَةُ الْقَلْبِ تُجْعَلُ الْقَلْبَ خَالِيًا مِنَ الْعَقَائِدِ الْفَاسِدَةِ وَالْمَذَاهِبِ الْبَاطِلَةِ وَالْمَيْلِ إِلَى شَهَوَاتِ الدُّنْيَا وَلَذَّاتِهَا. هُوَ قَلْبٌ قَدْ اسْتَسْلَمَ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ.

قَلْبٌ لَمْ يُجْرِفْهُ حُبُّ الشَّهَوَاتِ مِنَ النِّسَاءِ وَالْبَنِينَ وَالْقَنَاطِيرِ الْمُقَنْطَرَةِ مِنَ الذَّهَبِ وَالْفِضَّةِ وَالْخَيْلِ الْمُسَوَّمَةِ وَالْأَنْعَامِ وَالْحَرْثِ.

قَلْبٌ لَمْ يَشْغَلْهُ الْمَالُ وَالْبَنُونَ عَنْ طَاعَةِ رَبِّهِ وَالْإِخْبَاتِ إِلَيْهِ. قَلْبٌ وَجَلَ بِذِكْرِ اللَّهِ.

What is important is not only the purity of the body and the splendor of the clothes, but rather the soundness and goodness of the heart, for if it is good, the rest of the body is good.

Narrated An-Nu'man bin Bashir: I heard Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) saying, '**Both legal and illegal things are evident but in between them there are doubtful (suspicious) things and most of the people have no knowledge about them. So whoever saves himself from these suspicious things saves his religion and his honor. And whoever indulges in these suspicious things is like a shepherd who grazes (his animals) near the Hima (private pasture) of someone else and at any moment he is liable to get in it. (O people!) Beware! Every king has a Hima and the Hima of Allah on the earth is His illegal (forbidden) things. Beware! There is a piece of flesh in the body if it becomes good (reformed) the whole body becomes good but if it gets spoilt the whole body gets spoilt and that is the heart.**

It is what Allah looks at. Allah Almighty looks at hearts and deeds, not at breasts and bodies.

Abu Huraira reported Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) as saying: **Verily Allah does not look to your faces and your wealth but He looks to your heart and to your deeds.**

The affairs of hearts are entrusted to Allah Almighty, for He alone, Glory be to Him, is aware of them.

فَلَيْسَتْ الْعِبْرَةُ فَقَطْ بِظَهَارَةِ الْبَدَنِ وَبَهَاءِ الثِّيَابِ بَلْ لَا بُدَّ مِنْ سَلَامَةِ الْقَلْبِ وَصَلَاحِهِ، فَبِصَلَاحِهِ يَصْلُحُ سَائِرُ الْجَسَدِ.

عَنْ النُّعْمَانَ بْنِ بَشِيرٍ، يَقُولُ سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ " الْحَلَالُ بَيْنَ وَالْحَرَامِ بَيْنَ، وَبَيْنَهُمَا مُشَبَّهَاتٌ لَا يَعْلَمُهَا كَثِيرٌ مِنَ النَّاسِ، فَمَنْ اتَّقَى الْمُسَبَّهَاتِ اسْتَبْرَأَ لِدِينِهِ وَعِرْضِهِ، وَمَنْ وَقَعَ فِي الشُّبُهَاتِ كَرَّاعٍ يَزْعَى حَوْلَ الْحِمَى، يُوشِكُ أَنْ يُوَاقِعَهُ. أَلَا وَإِنَّ لِكُلِّ مَلِكٍ حِمًى، أَلَا إِنَّ حِمَى اللَّهِ فِي أَرْضِهِ مَحَارِمُهُ، أَلَا وَإِنَّ فِي الْجَسَدِ مُضْغَةً إِذَا صَلَحَتْ صَلَحَ الْجَسَدُ كُلُّهُ، وَإِذَا فَسَدَتْ فَسَدَ الْجَسَدُ كُلُّهُ. أَلَا وَهِيَ الْقَلْبُ".

وَهُوَ الَّذِي يَنْظُرُ اللَّهُ إِلَيْهِ فَاللَّهُ تَعَالَى يَنْظُرُ إِلَى الْقُلُوبِ وَالْأَعْمَالِ لَا إِلَى الصُّدُورِ وَالْأَجْسَادِ.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ "إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَنْظُرُ إِلَى صُورِكُمْ وَأَمْوَالِكُمْ وَلَكِنْ يَنْظُرُ إِلَى قُلُوبِكُمْ وَأَعْمَالِكُمْ".

فَأَمْرُ الْقُلُوبِ مَوْكُولٌ إِلَى اللَّهِ تَعَالَى فَهُوَ وَحْدَهُ سُبْحَانَهُ الْمُطَّلِعُ عَلَيْهَا.

The cause of corruption and hardness of heart

First: Polytheism in all its forms:

Such as believing that benefit and harm come from other than Allah, glory be to Him, and like resorting to the law other than Allah's law, preferring it to the Allah's law, and seeking relief, help, and support from other than Allah, glory be to Him.

The heart is still anxious, disturbed, and terrified, unable to find a solution, and its owner's mind is not at rest as long as he is a polytheist.

Allah says: **"We will cast horror into the hearts of the disbelievers for associating 'false gods' with Allah—a practice He has never authorized. The Fire will be their home—what an evil place for the wrongdoers to stay!"** (Ali imran: 151)

The Muslim is also obligated to purify his heart of the hidden and small polytheism, which is hypocrisy that could bring fire to its owner and cause voidness to his good deeds.

On the authority of Abu Hurayrah (may Allah be pleased with him), who said that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said: **Allah (glorified and exalted be He) said: I am so self-sufficient that I am in no need of having an associate. Thus he who does an action for someone else's sake as well as Mine will have that action renounced by Me to him whom he associated with Me.**¹

¹ It was related by Muslim 2985

أسباب فساد قسوة القلب

أولاً: الشرك بالله بكافة صورته:

كَاعْتِقَادِ النَّفْعِ وَالضَّرِّ فِي غَيْرِ اللَّهِ سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى، وَكَالتَّحَاكُمِ عَلَى غَيْرِ شَرِيعَةِ اللَّهِ مُؤَثِّرِينَ لَهَا عَلَى شَرِيعَةِ اللَّهِ، وَكَطَلَبِ الْغُوثِ وَالْعَوْنِ وَالْمَدَدِ مِنْ غَيْرِ اللَّهِ سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى. فَالْقَلْبُ لَا يَزَالُ قَلِقًا مُضْطَرِبًا مَرْغُوبًا، لَا يَقْرَرُ لَهُ قَرَارٌ، وَلَا يَهْدَى لِصَاحِبِهِ بَالٌ مَا دَامَ مُشْرِكًا.

قَالَ تَعَالَى: " سَنُلْقِي فِي قُلُوبِ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا الرُّعْبَ بِمَا أَشْرَكُوا بِاللَّهِ مَا لَمْ يُنَزَّلْ بِهِ سُلْطَانًا وَمَأْوَاهُمُ النَّارُ وَبِئْسَ مَثْوًى الظَّالِمِينَ " (ال عمران: 151)

وَيَلْزَمُ الْمُسْلِمَ أَيْضًا أَنْ يُظَهِّرَ قَلْبَهُ مِنْ خَفِيِّ الشَّرْكِ وَيَسِيرِهِ، وَهُوَ الرِّيَاءُ الَّذِي يُجْلِبُ لِصَاحِبِهِ النِّيرَانَ وَحُبُوطَ الْعَمَلِ.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ، قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: " قَالَ اللَّهُ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى: أَنَا أَغْنَى الشُّرَكَاءِ عَنِ الشَّرْكِ؛ مَنْ عَمِلَ عَمَلًا أَشْرَكَ مَعِيَ غَيْرِي، تَرَكْتُهُ وَشِرْكُهُ " ¹

On the authority of Abu Hurayrah (may Allah be pleased with him), who said: I heard the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) say: **The first of people against whom judgment will be pronounced on the Day of Resurrection will be a man who died a martyr. He will be brought and Allah will make known to him His favours and he will recognize them. [The Almighty] will say: And what did you do about them? He will say: I fought for you until I died a martyr. He will say: You have lied - you did but fight that it might be said [of you]: He is courageous. And so it was said. Then he will be ordered to be dragged along on his face until he is cast into Hell-fire.**

[Another] will be a man who has studied [religious] knowledge and has taught it and who used to recite the Quran. He will be brought and Allah will make known to him His favours and he will recognize them. [The Almighty] will say: And what did you do about them? He will say: I studied [religious] knowledge and I taught it and I recited the Quran for Your sake. He will say: You have lied - you did but study [religious] knowledge that it might be said [of you]: He is learned. And you recited the Quran that it might be said [of you]: He is a reciter. And so it was said. Then he will be ordered to be dragged along on his face until he is cast into Hell-fire.

[Another] will be a man whom Allah had made rich and to whom He had given all kinds of wealth. He will be brought and Allah will make known to him His favours and he will recognize them. [The Almighty] will say: And what did you do about them? He will say: I left no path [untrodden] in which You like money to be spent without spending in it for Your sake. He will say: You have lied - you did but do so that it might be said [of you]: He is open-handed. And so it was said. Then he will be ordered to be dragged along on his face until he is cast into Hell-fire. ¹.

¹ Narrated by Muslim (1905)

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ، قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ: " إِنَّ أَوَّلَ النَّاسِ يُقْضَى يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ عَلَيْهِ رَجُلٌ اسْتَشْهَدَ، فَأُتِيَ بِهِ فَعَرَّفَهُ نِعَمَهُ فَعَرَفَهَا، قَالَ: فَمَا عَمِلْتُ فِيهَا؟ قَالَ قَاتَلْتُ فِيكَ حَتَّى اسْتَشْهَدْتُ، قَالَ: كَذَبْتَ، وَلَكِنَّكَ قَاتَلْتَ لِأَنْ يُقَالَ: جَرِيءٌ، فَقَدْ قِيلَ، ثُمَّ أُمِرَ بِهِ فَسُحِبَ عَلَى وَجْهِهِ حَتَّى أُلْقِيَ فِي النَّارِ.

وَرَجُلٌ تَعَلَّمَ الْعِلْمَ وَعَلَّمَهُ وَقَرَأَ الْقُرْآنَ، فَأُتِيَ بِهِ، فَعَرَّفَهُ نِعَمَهُ فَعَرَفَهَا، قَالَ: فَمَا عَمِلْتُ فِيهَا؟ قَالَ: تَعَلَّمْتُ الْعِلْمَ وَعَلَّمْتُهُ، وَقَرَأْتُ فِيكَ الْقُرْآنَ، قَالَ: كَذَبْتَ، وَلَكِنَّكَ تَعَلَّمْتَ الْعِلْمَ لِيُقَالَ: عَالِمٌ، وَقَرَأْتَ الْقُرْآنَ لِيُقَالَ: هُوَ قَارِئٌ، فَقَدْ قِيلَ، ثُمَّ أُمِرَ بِهِ، فَسُحِبَ عَلَى وَجْهِهِ حَتَّى أُلْقِيَ فِي النَّارِ.

وَرَجُلٌ وَسَّعَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ، وَأَعْطَاهُ مِنْ أَصْنَافِ الْمَالِ كُلِّهِ، فَأُتِيَ بِهِ، فَعَرَّفَهُ نِعَمَهُ فَعَرَفَهَا، قَالَ: فَمَا عَمِلْتُ فِيهَا؟ قَالَ: مَا تَرَكَتُ مِنْ سَبِيلٍ تُحِبُّ أَنْ يُنْفَقَ فِيهَا إِلَّا أَنْفَقْتُ فِيهَا لَكَ، قَالَ: كَذَبْتَ، وَلَكِنَّكَ فَعَلْتَ لِيُقَالَ: هُوَ جَوَادٌّ، فَقَدْ قِيلَ، ثُمَّ أُمِرَ بِهِ فَسُحِبَ عَلَى وَجْهِهِ، ثُمَّ أُلْقِيَ فِي النَّارِ".¹

Second: Turning away from the truth, following other than the path of the believers and innovation in religion

Allah Almighty said: "**So when they 'persistently' deviated, Allah caused their hearts to deviate. For Allah does not guide the rebellious people..**" (As-Saf 5)

Allah Almighty said: "**Then they slip away. It is' Allah 'Who' has turned their hearts away because they are a people who do not comprehend.**" (At-Twba: 127)

Third: the hatred and envy to the believers.

That is why the supplication of the righteous was: **"Our Lord! Forgive us and our fellow believers who preceded us in faith, and do not allow bitterness into our hearts towards those who believe."** (Al-Hashr: 10)

Fourth: Sins of all kinds.

Allah Almighty said: "**But no! In fact, their hearts have been stained by all 'the evil' they used to commit!.**" (Al-Mutafifeen: 14)

Abu Hurairah narrated that: the Messenger of Allah said: **"Verily, when the slave (of Allah) commits a sin, a black spot appears on his heart. When he refrains from it, seeks forgiveness and repents, his heart is polished clean. But if he returns, it increases until it covers his entire heart. And that is the 'Ran' which Allah mentioned: 'Nay, but on their hearts is the Ran which they used to earn.'"** (Al-Mutafifeen: 14)¹

¹ Narrated by Ahmad (2/287) and Al-Tirmidhi (3334)

**ثَانِيًا: الإِعْرَاضُ عَنِ الْحَقِّ وَاتِّبَاعُ غَيْرِ سَبِيلِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ
وَالِإِبْتِدَاعِ وَالْإِحْدَاثِ فِي الدِّينِ**

قَالَ تَعَالَى: " فَلَمَّا زَاغُوا أَزَاغَ اللَّهُ قُلُوبَهُمْ ۗ وَاللَّهُ لَا يَهْدِي الْقَوْمَ الْفَاسِقِينَ " (الصف: 5)

قَالَ تَعَالَى: " ثُمَّ أَنْصَرَفُوا ۖ صَرَفَ اللَّهُ قُلُوبَهُمْ بِأَنَّهُمْ قَوْمٌ لَا يَفْقَهُونَ " (التوبة: 127)

ثَالِثًا: الْغِلَّ وَالْحَسَدَ لِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ.

وَلِذَلِكَ كَانَتْ دَعْوَةُ الصَّالِحِينَ: " رَبَّنَا اغْفِرْ لَنَا وَلِإِخْوَانِنَا الَّذِينَ سَبَقُونَا بِالْإِيمَانِ وَلَا تَجْعَلْ فِي قُلُوبِنَا غِلًّا لِلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا " (الحشر: 10)

رَابِعًا: الْمَعَاصِيَ بِجُمْلَتِهَا.

قَالَ تَعَالَى: " كَلَّا بَلْ رَانَ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ مَا كَانُوا يَكْسِبُونَ " [المطففين: 14]

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ " إِنَّ الْعَبْدَ إِذَا أَخْطَأَ خَطِيئَةً نَكَتَتْ فِي قَلْبِهِ نَكْتَةً سَوْدَاءٌ فَإِذَا هُوَ نَزَعَ وَاسْتَغْفَرَ وَتَابَ سَقَلَ قَلْبُهُ وَإِنْ عَادَ زِيدَ فِيهَا حَتَّى تَعْلُو قَلْبَهُ وَهُوَ الرَّانُ الَّذِي ذَكَرَ اللَّهُ: (كَلَّا بَلْ رَانَ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ مَا كَانُوا يَكْسِبُونَ) ". [المطففين: 14]¹

¹ أخرجه أحمد (287/2) والترمذي (3334)

Hudhaifa said: I heard the Messenger of Allah (may peace be, upon him) observing: **"Temptations will be presented to men's hearts as reed mat is woven stick by stick and any heart which is impregnated by them will have a black mark put into it, but any heart which rejects them will have a white mark put in it. The result is that there will become two types of hearts: one white like a white stone which will not be harmed by any turmoil or temptation, so long as the heavens and the earth endure; and the other black and dust-coloured like a vessel which is upset, not recognizing what is good or rejecting what is abominable, but being impregnated with passion."**¹

Fifth: Breaking covenants.

By breaking the covenant, the heart becomes hardened. Allah Almighty said: **" But no! In fact, their hearts have been stained by all 'the evil' they used to commit!."** (Al-Madaa: 13)

Sixth: concealing the testimony.

Allah Almighty said: **"And do not conceal the testimony, for whoever conceals it, their hearts are indeed sinful."** (Al-Baqra: 283)

Seventh: Softness of women in speech.

Allah Almighty commanded women to abandon softness in speech with men. Allah Almighty said: **" then do not be overly effeminate in speech 'with men' or those with sickness in their hearts may be tempted, but speak in a moderate tone."** (Al-Ahzab: 32)

¹ Narrated by Muslim 144

قَالَ حُذَيْفَةُ سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ
 " تُعْرَضُ الْفِتْنُ عَلَى الْقُلُوبِ كَالْحَصِيرِ عُوْدًا عُوْدًا فَأَيُّ قَلْبٍ
 أَشْرَبَهَا نُكِتَ فِيهِ نُكْتَةٌ سَوْدَاءٌ وَأَيُّ قَلْبٍ أَنْكَرَهَا نُكِتَ فِيهِ
 نُكْتَةٌ بَيْضَاءٌ حَتَّى تَصِيرَ عَلَى قَلْبَيْنِ عَلَى أَبْيَضَ مِثْلِ الصَّفَا
 فَلَا تَضُرُّهُ فِتْنَةٌ مَا دَامَتِ السَّمَوَاتُ وَالْأَرْضُ وَالْآخِرُ أَسْوَدُ
 مُرْبَادًا كَالْكُوزِ مُجَخَّيًّا لَا يَعْرِفُ مَعْرُوفًا وَلَا يُنْكِرُ مُنْكَرًا إِلَّا مَا
 أَشْرَبَ مِنْ هَوَاهُ" ¹.

خَامِسًا: نَقْضُ الْعُهُودِ وَالْمَوَاقِيقِ.

فَبِنَقْضِ الْعَهْدِ يَقْسُو الْقَلْبُ، قَالَ تَعَالَى: "فَبِمَا نَقَضْتُمْ
 مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَجَعَلْنَا قُلُوبَهُمْ قَاسِيَةً" [المائدة: 13].

سَادِسًا: كِتْمَانُ الشَّهَادَةِ.

قَالَ تَعَالَى: "وَلَا تَكْتُمُوا الشَّهَادَةَ ۚ وَمَنْ يَكْتُمْهَا فَإِنَّهُ دَخَلَ
 قَلْبُهُ" [البقرة: 283].

سَابِعًا: خُضُوعُ النِّسَاءِ بِالْقَوْلِ.

أَمَرَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى النِّسَاءَ بِتَرْكِ الْخُضُوعِ بِالْقَوْلِ؛ فَقَالَ تَعَالَى:
 "فَلَا تَخْضَعْنَ بِالْقَوْلِ فَيَطْمَعَ الَّذِي فِي قَلْبِهِ مَرَضٌ وَقُلْنَ
 قَوْلًا مَعْرُوفًا" [الأحزاب: 32].

Eighth: Excessive talking without mentioning Allah and excessive laughter.

Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: (Do not laugh too much, for too much laughter kills the heart).¹

Ninth: Eating too much, especially if it is questionable or forbidden sources.

Bishr bin Al-Harith said: (Two qualities harden the heart: too much talking and too much eating)²

Al-Marwadhi mentioned in the Book of Piety, he said: I said to Abu Abdullah i.e. Ahmad bin Hanbal -: Does a man find tenderness in his heart when he is satisfied? He said: I don't see that.³

¹ Narrated by Ibn Abi Shaybah in Al-Musannaf (5/338)

² Narrated by Abu Naim in Al-Hilya (8/350) and Al-Bayhaqi in Al-Shu'ab (5705)

³ (p. 120) Chapter on reducing and abandoning desires, Dar Ibn Rajab.

ثَامِنًا: كثرة الكلام بغير ذكر الله وكثرة الضحك.

قال الحسن البصري: (لا تكثروا الضحك فإن كثرة الضحك تميت القلب).¹

تاسعًا: كثرة الأكل لاسيما إن كان من الشبهات أو الحرام.

قال بشر بن الحارث: (خصلتان تقسيان القلب كثرة الكلام وكثرة الأكل)²

وذكر المروذي في كتاب الورع، قال: قلت لأبي عبد الله - يعني أحمد بن حنبل -: يجد الرجل من قلبه رقه وهو يشبع؟ قال: ما أرى³

¹ أخرجه ابن أبي شيبة في المصنف (5 / 338)

² أخرجه أبو نعيم في الحلية (8 / 350) والبيهقي في الشعب (5705)

³ (ص 120) باب التقليل وترك الشهوات طز دار ابن رجب.

Reasons of soundness of the heart

1- Believing in Allah Almighty, pleasing with his decree and being patient with his affliction:

Allah Almighty said: **“And whoever believes in Allāh - He will guide his heart”** (Attaghabun: 11)

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: **“Strange are the ways of a believer for there is good in every affair of his and this is not the case with anyone else except in the case of a believer for if he has an occasion to feel delight, he thanks (God), thus there is a good for him in it, and if he gets into trouble and shows resignation (and endures it patiently), there is a good for him in it.”**¹

2- Remembrance of Allah:

Allah Almighty said: **“Those who have believed and whose hearts are assured by the remembrance of Allāh. Unquestionably, by the remembrance of Allāh hearts are assured. Those who have believed and done righteous deeds - a good state is theirs and a good return.”** (Arra'd: 28- 29)

Allah Almighty said: **“then their skins and their hearts relax at the remembrance [i.e., mention] of Allāh.”** (Azzumar: 23)

Al-Muala b. Ziyad said: “Verily, a man said to al-Hasan, ‘O Abu Sa'Id, I complain to you about the hardness of my heart.’” So he responded, ‘Bring it closer to [i.e. treat it with] the remembrance [of Allah]²’”.

¹ Sahih Muslim (2999)

² Ibn Abi Addunya in Softening and weeping (48), Ahmed in Az-Zuhd (p. 454)

أَسْبَابُ سَلَامَةِ الْقُلُوبِ

1-الإيمان بالله عز وجل والرضا بقضائه والصبر على بلائه:

قال الله عز وجل: **"وَمَنْ يُؤْمِنْ بِاللَّهِ يَهْدِ اللَّهُ قَلْبَهُ"** [التغابن: 11]

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: **"عَجَبًا لِأَمْرِ الْمُؤْمِنِ إِنَّ أَمْرَهُ كُلَّهُ خَيْرٌ وَلَيْسَ ذَاكَ لِأَحَدٍ إِلَّا لِلْمُؤْمِنِ إِنْ أَصَابَتْهُ سَرَاءٌ شَكَرَ فَكَانَ خَيْرًا لَهُ وَإِنْ أَصَابَتْهُ ضَرَاءٌ صَبَرَ فَكَانَ خَيْرًا لَهُ"**.¹

2-ذكر الله سبحانه وتعالى:

قَالَ اللَّهُ سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى: **"الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا وَتَطْمَئِنُّ قُلُوبُهُمْ بِذِكْرِ اللَّهِ أَلَا بِذِكْرِ اللَّهِ تَطْمَئِنُّ الْقُلُوبُ. الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ طُوبَى لَهُمْ وَحُسْنُ مَآبٍ"** [الرعد: 28-29]

وَقَالَ سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى: **"ثُمَّ تَلَيْنُ جُلُودَهُمْ وَقُلُوبُهُمْ إِلَى ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ"** [الزمر: 23]

قَالَ الْمُعَلَّى بْنُ زِيَادٍ: **"إِنْ رَجُلًا قَالَ لِلْحَسَنِ: يَا أَبَا سَعِيدٍ، أَشْكُو إِلَيْكَ قَسْوَةَ قَلْبِي"**. قَالَ: أَذِبه الذِّكْر.²

¹ صحيح أخرجه مسلم (2999)

² رواه ابن أبي الدنيا في الرقة والبكاء (48)، وأحمد في الزهد (ص 454)

3- Religious knowledge:

It is knowledge of the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger; peace be upon him. With it, the believer wakes up from his heedless, becomes aware, and struggles himself.

If his heart is stained, he hastens to seek forgiveness to remove it. Returning the rights to their rightful owners.

As an example of the impact of religious knowledge on the causes of corruption of hearts, for example, we cite as an example one of the causes of corruption of hearts mentioned above, which is envy

If the Muslim knows that by his envy of someone, he objects to Allah's decree and destiny, as Allah is the one who divides livelihoods. He, Glory be to Him, is the one who gives and prevents. He is the Honourer, the Humiliator He gives authority to whoever He pleases and remove it from who He pleases and leaves whoever He wills infertile.

If he knows that Allah is the Withholder, the Plentiful Giver, the Abaser, the Exalter

If he knows all of that, he will be certain that by his envy of a Muslim, he objects to Allah's division and decree.

So he is rebuked and stops his envy towards the envied, so Allah will soften his heart and those sins that envy had brought upon him would not accumulate in his heart.

3- العلم الشرعي:

الَّذِي هُوَ الْعِلْمُ بِكِتَابِ اللَّهِ وَبِسُنَّةِ رَسُولِهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، فِيهِ يَسْتَقِظُ الْمُؤْمِنُ مِنْ غَفْلَتِهِ وَيَتَفَقَّنُ وَيُجَالِدُ نَفْسَهُ.

فَإِذَا رَانَ عَلَى قَلْبِهِ رَانٌ، بَادَرَ بِالِاسْتِغْفَارِ لِإِزَالَتِهِ، وَبِإِدَاءِ الْحُقُوقِ إِلَى أَهْلِهَا لِمَحْوِهِ.

وَكِمِثَالٍ لِأَثَرِ الْعِلْمِ الشَّرْعِيِّ عَلَى مُسَبِّبَاتِ فَسَادِ الْقُلُوبِ مَثَلًا، نَسُوقُ مَثَلًا لَذَلِكَ سَبَبًا مِنْ أَسْبَابِ فَسَادِ الْقُلُوبِ الْمَذْكُورَةِ وَهُوَ الْحَسَدُ.

فَإِذَا عَلِمَ الْمُسْلِمُ أَنَّهُ بِحَسَدِهِ لِلشَّخْصِ مُعْتَرِضًا عَلَى قَضَاءِ اللَّهِ وَقَدَرِهِ، فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ هُوَ الَّذِي يُقَسِّمُ الْأَرْزَاقَ، هُوَ سُبْحَانَهُ الْمُعْزِ الْمُدِلُ يُؤْتِي الْمُلْكَ مَنْ يَشَاءُ وَيَنْزِعُ الْمُلْكَ مِمَّنْ يَشَاءُ وَيَجْعَلُ مَنْ يَشَاءُ عَقِيمًا.

إِذَا عَلِمَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ هُوَ الْقَابِضُ الْبَاسِطُ الْخَافِضُ الرَّافِعُ....

إِذَا عَلِمَ ذَلِكَ كُلَّهُ تَيَقَّنَ وَتَأَكَّدَ أَنَّهُ بِحَسَدِهِ لِلْمُسْلِمِ مُعْتَرِضًا عَلَى تَقْسِيمِ اللَّهِ وَأَقْدَارِ اللَّهِ، فَانْزَجَرَ وَكَفَّ حَسَدَهُ عَنِ الْمَحْسُودِ فَيَطِيبُ اللَّهُ قَلْبَهُ وَلَا تَتَرَاكُمُ عَلَى قَلْبِهِ تِلْكَ الذُّنُوبُ الَّتِي جَرَّهَا إِلَيْهِ الْحَسَدُ.

If the envious person knows that he is imitating the polytheists, because the polytheists are the ones who desire the disappearance of goodness from the believers, descending of calamities, vengeance, illnesses, and ailments upon them, immorality spreads among them, and it is made public among them.

If he knows that the polytheists envied the Messenger of Allah for his prophecy and said: "**And they said, "Why was this Qur'ān not sent down upon a great man from [one of] the two cities? Do they distribute the mercy of your Lord? It is We who have apportioned among them their livelihood in the life of this world and have raised some of them above others in degrees [of rank] that they may make use of one another for service. But the mercy of your Lord is better than whatever they accumulate."**

(Azzukhruf: 31:32)

If a Muslim knows this, he will be repelled from his resemblance to the polytheists, and then he will be repelled from his envy of the believers, so his heart would be blessed, purified, and polished.

If the envious person knows that he is imitating the devils, answering Satan's desire, because Satan is the one who wishes for the disappearance of all blessings from the believers, and hopes that they will all end up in hell.

If the envious person knew this, and knew that by envying the believer, he would fulfill and satisfy Satan's desire, and give him what he wishes and wants, he would stop his envy and hasten to repent, pray for the believers instead of praying against them and wish goodness for them instead of wishing if it would go away from them, and thus his heart would be whitened and his deeds would be purified.

إِذَا عَلِمَ الْحَاسِدُ أَنَّهُ مُتَشَبِّهٌ بِالْمُشْرِكِينَ، فَإِنَّ الْمُشْرِكِينَ هُمُ الَّذِينَ يَرِغُبُونَ فِي زَوَالِ الْخَيْرِ عَنِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَنُزُولِ الْبَلَايَا وَالنِّقَمِ وَالْأَمْرَاضِ وَالْأَسْقَامِ عَلَيْهِمْ وَتَفْسِثِي الْفَاحِشَةِ فِيهِمْ وَالْجَهْرِ بِهَا فِي أَوْسَاطِهِمْ.

إِذَا عَلِمَ أَنَّ الْمُشْرِكِينَ حَسَدُوا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ عَلَي نُبُوتِهِ وَقَالُوا: **"وَقَالُوا لَوْلَا نُزِّلَ هَذَا الْقُرْآنُ عَلَى رَجُلٍ مِّنَ الْقَرْيَتَيْنِ عَظِيمٍ. أَهُمُ يَقْسِمُونَ رَحْمَتَ رَبِّكَ ۖ نَحْنُ قَسَمْنَا بَيْنَهُمْ مَّعِيشَتَهُمْ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا وَرَفَعْنَا بَعْضَهُمْ فَوْقَ بَعْضٍ دَرَجَاتٍ لِّيَتَّخِذَ بَعْضُهُم بَعْضًا سَخِرِيًّا ۖ وَرَحِمَتْ رَبِّكَ خَيْرٌ مِّمَّا يَجْمَعُونَ"** [الزخرف: 31-32].

إِذَا عَلِمَ الْمُسْلِمُ ذَلِكَ، لَانْزَجَرَ عَنْ تَشَبُّهِهِ بِالْمُشْرِكِينَ، وَمِنْ ثَمَّ انْزَجَرَ عَنْ حَسَدِهِ لِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ فَطَابَ قَلْبُهُ وَطَهَّرَ وَصَقُلَ.

إِذَا عَلِمَ الْحَاسِدُ أَنَّهُ مُتَشَبِّهٌ بِالشَّيَاطِينِ، وَمُلَبِّ لِإِبْلِيسَ رَغْبَتِهِ، فَإِنَّ الشَّيْطَانَ هُوَ الَّذِي يَتَمَنَّى زَوَالِ جَمِيعِ النِّعَمِ عَنِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ، وَيَتَمَنَّى أَنْ يَكُونَ مَالَهُمْ جَمِيعًا إِلَى الْجَحِيمِ.

إِذَا عَلِمَ الْحَاسِدُ ذَلِكَ، وَعَلِمَ أَنَّهُ بِحَسَدِهِ لِلْمُؤْمِنِ يُلَبِّي وَيُشْبِعُ لِإِبْلِيسَ رَغْبَتَهُ وَشَهْوَتَهُ، وَيُعْطِيهِ مَنَالَهُ وَمُرَادَهُ، لَانْكَفَّ عَنْ حَسَدِهِ، وَبَادَرَ بِالتَّوْبَةِ وَالِدُّعَاءِ لِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ بِدَلَا مِنَ الدُّعَاءِ عَلَيْهِمْ، وَتَمَنَّى الْخَيْرَ لَهُمْ بِدَلَا مِنْ تَمَنَّى زَوَالِهِ عَنْهُمْ، وَمِنْ ثَمَّ يَبْيِضُ قَلْبُهُ وَيَزْكُو عَمَلُهُ.

If the envious person knows that by his envy of people, he angers Allah Almighty and brings Allah's hatred towards him. What wrath and hatred is greater than the wrath and hatred of Allah?! May Allah protect us and the Muslims from that.

If the envious person knew that, and knew that **when Allah hates a slave, He calls Jibril and says: 'I hate so- and-so, so hate him.'** Then Jibril also hates him. He (Jibril) then **announces amongst the inhabitants of heavens: 'Verily, Allah hates so- and-so, so you also hate him.'** Thus they also start to **hate him. Then he becomes the object of hatred on the earth also".¹**

If the envious person knew all of this, he would repent and hasten to turn to his Lord and seek His forgiveness.

If the envious person knows that he is bringing people's hatred towards him because they know that he wishes the blessing to be removed from them, then they will hate him as he hates them, and they wish that the blessing would be removed from him just as he wishes that the blessing would be removed from them.

If he knew that, he would abandon his envy and thus purify his heart.

If the envious person knows that he will not harm people at all and will only harm himself.

إِذَا عَلِمَ الْحَاسِدُ أَنَّهُ بِحَسَدِهِ لِلنَّاسِ يُغْضِبُ اللَّهَ سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ، وَيُجْلِبَ مَقْتُ اللَّهِ لَهُ، وَأَيُّ غَضَبٍ وَأَيُّ مَقْتٍ أَكْبَرَ مِنْ غَضَبِ اللَّهِ وَمَقْتِ اللَّهِ؟! عَافَانَا اللَّهُ وَالْمُسْلِمِينَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ.

إِذَا عَلِمَ الْحَاسِدُ هَذَا، وَأَنَّ اللَّهَ إِذَا أَبْغَضَ عَبْدًا نَادَى جِبْرِيلَ فِي أَهْلِ السَّمَاءِ "إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُبْغِضُ فُلَانًا فَأَبْغِضُوهُ، فَيُبْغِضُهُ أَهْلُ السَّمَاءِ ثُمَّ تَوْضِعُ لَهُ الْبَغْضَاءُ فِي الْأَرْضِ".¹

إِذَا عَلِمَ الْحَاسِدُ هَذَا كُلَّهُ لَتَابَ وَأَسْرَعَ فِي الْإِنَابَةِ وَإِلَى رَبِّهِ وَالِاسْتِغْفَارِ إِلَيْهِ.

إِذَا عَلِمَ الْحَاسِدُ أَنَّهُ يُجْلِبُ كَرَاهِيَّةَ النَّاسِ لَهُ لِمَا يَعْلَمُونَ مِنْهُ مِنْ تَمَنِّيهِ لِرِزْوَالِ النِّعْمَةِ عَنْهُمْ، فَيُبْغِضُونَهُ كَمَا يُبْغِضُهُمْ، وَيَكْرَهُونَهُ كَمَا يَكْرَهُهُمْ، وَيَمْقُتُونَهُ كَمَا يَمْقُتُهُمْ، وَيَتَمَنُّونَ زَوَالَ النِّعْمَةِ عَنْهُ كَمَا يَتَمَنَّى زَوَالَ النِّعْمَةِ عَنْهُمْ.

إِذَا عَلِمَ ذَلِكَ لَتَرَكَ حَسَدَهُ وَمِنْ ثَمَّ طَهَّرَ قَلْبَهُ.

إِذَا عَلِمَ الْحَاسِدُ أَنَّهُ لَنْ يَضُرَّ النَّاسَ شَيْئًا، وَلَنْ يَضُرَّ إِلَّا نَفْسَهُ

¹ أخرجه البخاري (6040، 3209) ومسلم (2637)

Allah gives abundant provisions to people even though they are in great distress.

Allah heals and honours whoever He pleases, even though the slave is in excessive anxiety.

Allah gives abundant provisions sons and daughters to whoever He wills, while They are in constant distress and continuous anguish.

Allah exalts His servants and increases their disappointment and confusion.

Allah honours His servants and increases their humiliation and disgrace.

If the envious person knew all of that, he would give up his envy of people and go to sleep without having any jealousy towards anyone in his heart.

If the envious person knows that his example with the envied is that like a man who took a stone to throw it in the face of another person, then he threw it forcefully towards his face, but the man missed it and the stone bounced back on the thrower's eye gouging out his eye. The thrower's anger intensified, so he took another stone and threw it with greater force at his enemy's eye. but the enemy missed it and it bounced back on the thrower's other eye gouging out it. the thrower's rage intensified and became strong and intense, so he started throwing a large rock using his strength and force to his enemy's head, but it missed the enemy and it landed on he head of its thrower. so It smashed his head, so it gouged out the thrower's two eyes and smashed his head, and the other was not harmed and not any kind of harm befell him. **"But evil plotting only backfires on those who plot."** (Fatr: 43) **"but far worse is the punishment of the Hereafter, if only they knew."** (Az-Zumar: 26) **"but the punishment of the Hereafter is truly far worse. And none can shield them from Allah."** (Ar-Raad: 34)

فَاللَّهُ يَبْسُطُ الرِّزْقَ عَلَى النَّاسِ وَهُمْ فِي هَمٍّ زَائِدٍ.
 وَاللَّهُ يُعَافِي وَيُعِزُّ مَنْ يَشَاءُ وَهُوَ فِي قَلْقٍ زَائِدٍ.
 وَاللَّهُ يَرْزُقُ مَنْ يَشَاءُ الْبَنِينَ وَالْبَنَاتِ وَهُمْ فِي نَكْدٍ دَائِمٍ وَكَرْبٍ
 مُتَّصِلٍ.

يَرْفَعُ اللَّهُ الْعِبَادَ وَيَزِيدُهُمْ خَيْبَةً وَخَبَالًا.
 يُعِزُّ اللَّهُ الْعِبَادَ وَيَزِيدُهُمْ مَذَلَّةً وَهَوَانًا.
 إِذَا عَلِمَ الْحَاسِدُ ذَلِكَ كُفَّ، تَرَكَ حَسَدَ الْعِبَادِ وَلَنَامَ وَلَيْسَ فِي قَلْبِهِ
 دَغْلٌ لِأَحَدٍ.

إِذَا عَلِمَ الْحَاسِدُ أَنَّ مَثْلَهُ مَعَ الْمَحْسُودِ كَمَثَلِ رَجُلٍ أَخَذَ حَجَرًا
 لِيَقْذِفَهُ فِي وَجْهِ آخَرَ، فَقَذَفَهُ بِقُوَّةِ تَجَاهِ وَجْهِهِ، فَفَوَّتَهُ الرَّجُلُ فَارْتَدَّ
 الْحَجَرُ عَلَى عَيْنِ رَامِيهِ وَقَازِفُهُ فَقَقَأَ عَيْنَهُ، فَاشْتَدَّ غَضَبُ الرَّامِي
 فَأَخَذَ حَجَرًا آخَرَ فَرَمَاهُ بِقُوَّةٍ أَشَدَّ فِي عَيْنِ عَدُوِّهِ فَفَوَّتَهُ الْعَدُوُّ فَارْتَدَّ
 عَلَى عَيْنِ الرَّامِي الْأُخْرَى فَقَقَأَهَا، فَاشْتَدَّ حَنْقُ الرَّامِي وَاشْتَدَّ وَقْوِي
 غَيْظُهُ وَاحْتَدَّ، فَأَخَذَ صَخْرَةً كُبْرَى يَرْمِيهَا بِقُوَّتِهِ وَيَقْذِفُهَا بِشِدَّتِهِ
 عَلَى رَأْسِ عَدُوِّهِ، فَفَوَّتَهَا الْعَدُوُّ فَتَزَلَّتْ عَلَى رَأْسِ رَامِيهَا وَقَازِفُهَا
 فَهَشَّمَتْهُ، فَقَقَأَتْ عَيْنَا الرَّامِي وَهَشَّمَتْ رَأْسَهُ، وَالْآخِرُ لَمْ يُصَبْ
 بِسُوءٍ وَلَمْ يَنْلَهُ مَكْرُوهٌ "وَلَا يَحِيقُ الْمَكْرُ السَّيِّئُ إِلَّا بِأَهْلِهِ" [فاطر: 43].
 [26]. "وَلَعَذَابُ الْآخِرَةِ أَشَقُّ وَمَا لَهُمْ مِّنْ آلَهِ مِنْ وَاقٍ" [الرعد: 34].

If the envious person knew all of this, he would be rebuked and refrain from his envy, and would hasten to ask for forgiveness, which in turn purifies his heart and removes what is stained on it. So, the benefit of Islamic knowledge appears in purifying hearts, and this is just one of the examples. **“but none will understand them except the people of knowledge..”** (Al-Ankabut: 26)

4- Asking steadfastness from Allah Almighty:

A person may do deeds characteristic of the people of Paradise, so much so that there is only the distance of a cubit between him and it, and then what has been written (by the angel) surpasses, and he starts doing deeds of the people of the (Hell) Fire and enters the (Hell) Fire".

That's why, a supplication of believers, those of understanding and firm in knowledge, is **“Our Lord, let not our hearts deviate after You have guided us”** (Al-Imran: 8)

The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) would often say: **“O Changer of the Hearts! Strengthen my heart upon Your Religion.”**¹

The Prophet (ﷺ) frequently used to swear, **"No, by the One Who turns the hearts."**²

The Prophet (ﷺ) used to supplicate and say: **“..... and cleanse my heart from all the sins as a white garment is cleansed from the filth”**³

¹ Jami` at-Tirmidhi (2140) and others from Hadith of Anas

² Sahih al-Bukhari (7391) and others from Hadith of Ibn Omar

³ Sahih al-Bukhari (6368), Sahih Muslim (2705)

إِذَا عَلِمَ الْحَاسِدُ ذَلِكَ كُلَّهُ، لَانْزَجَرَ وَانْكَفَّ عَنْ حَسَدِهِ، وَلِبَادَرٍ
بِالْاسْتِغْفَارِ الَّذِي بِدَوْرِهِ يُظَهِّرُ قَلْبَهُ وَيُزِيلُ مَا رَانَ عَلَيْهِ، وَمِنْ
ثُمَّ تَظْهَرُ فَائِدَةُ الْعِلْمِ الشَّرْعِيِّ فِي تَظْهِيرِ الْقُلُوبِ، وَهَذَا كِمِثَالٍ
مِنَ الْأُمُثِلَةِ **"وَمَا يَعْقِلُهَا إِلَّا الْعَالِمُونَ"** [العنكبوت: 43].

4- سُؤَالُ الثَّبَاتِ مِنَ اللَّهِ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى:

فَإِنَّ الرَّجُلَ لَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلٍ أَهْلِ الْجَنَّةِ، حَتَّى مَا يَكُونُ بَيْنَهُ
وَبَيْنَهَا إِلَّا ذِرَاعٌ فَيَسْبِقُ عَلَيْهِ الْكِتَابُ، فَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلِ أَهْلِ النَّارِ
فَيَدْخُلُهَا.

وَلِذَلِكَ كَانَتْ دَعْوَةُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أُولَى الْأَبَابِ الرَّاسِخِينَ فِي
الْعِلْمِ: **"رَبَّنَا لَا تَزِغْ قُلُوبَنَا بَعْدَ إِذْ هَدَيْتَنَا"** [ال عمران: 8].

وَكَانَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يُكْثِرُ أَنْ يَقُولَ " يَا
مُقَلِّبَ الْقُلُوبِ، ثَبِّتْ قَلْبِي عَلَى دِينِكَ"¹

وَكَانَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ أَكْثَرُ مَا يَحْلِفُ "لَا وَمُقَلِّبِ
الْقُلُوبِ".²

وَكَانَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَدْعُو فَيَقُولُ: "..... وَنَقَّ قَلْبِي
مِنَ الْخَطَايَا، كَمَا نَقَّيْتَ الثَّوْبَ الْأَبْيَضَ مِنَ الدَّنَسِ"³

¹ أخرجه الترمذي (2140) وغيره من حديث أنس رضي الله عنه.

² أخرجه البخاري (7391) من حديث ابن عمر رضي الله عنه.

³ أخرجه البخاري (6368) ومسلم (2705)

The Prophet (ﷺ) used to also say: **"Yes. Indeed, the hearts of all human beings are between two Fingers of Allah's Fingers, as one heart, He changes them as He wills."**

Then Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: **"O Allah, the Turner of the hearts, turn our hearts to Thine obedience."**¹

And a supplication of believers also is **"and put not in our hearts [any] resentment toward those who have believed"** (Al-hashr: 10)

5- Keeping asking forgiveness:

That's why Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: **"There is (at times) some sort of shade upon my heart, and I seek forgiveness from Allah a hundred times a day"**²

Allah Almighty said to the wives of His prophet (ﷺ) when their hearts have deviated **"If you two [wives] repent to Allāh, [it is best], for your hearts have deviated"** (Attahreem: 4)

The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said: **"Verily, when the slave (of Allah) commits a sin, a black spot appears on his heart. When he refrains from it, seeks forgiveness and repents, his heart is polished clean. But if he returns, it increases until it covers his entire heart. And that is the 'Ran' which Allah mentioned: 'Nay, but on their hearts is the Ran which they used to earn.'"**

(Almutaffeen: 11)³

¹ Sahih Muslim 2654 from Hadith of Abdullah Ibn Amr Ibn Al'Aas

² Sahih Muslim 2702 from Hadith of Al'Aghar Almuzany

³ Hasan

وكان صلى الله عليه وسلم يقول كذلك "إِنَّ قُلُوبَ بَنِي آدَمَ كُلَّهَا
بَيْنَ إِصْبَعَيْنِ مِنْ أَصَابِعِ الرَّحْمَنِ، كَقَلْبٍ وَاحِدٍ، يُصْرَفُهُ حَيْثُ
يَشَاءُ "

ثم قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " اللَّهُمَّ مُصَرِّفَ
الْقُلُوبِ صَرِّفْ قُلُوبَنَا عَلَى طَاعَتِكَ ".¹

وكانت دعوة المؤمنين أيضًا: "وَلَا تَجْعَلْ فِي قُلُوبِنَا غِلًّا لِلَّذِينَ
ءَامَنُوا" [الحشر: 10].

5- كثرة الاستغفار وملازمته:

ولذلك كَانَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ: " إِنَّهُ لَيَغَانُ
عَلَى قَلْبِي وَإِنِّي لَأَسْتَغْفِرُ اللَّهَ فِي الْيَوْمِ مِائَةً مَرَّةً"²

وقال الله سُبحانه وتعالى لنساء نبيه صلى الله عليه وسلم لَمَّا
صَغَتْ قُلُوبُهُنَّ وَمَالَتْ: "إِنْ تَتُوبَا إِلَى اللَّهِ فَقَدْ صَغَتْ قُلُوبُكُمَا"
[التحریم: 4].

وقَالَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " إِنَّ الْعَبْدَ إِذَا أَخْطَأَ خَطِيئَةً نَكَّتْ
فِي قَلْبِهِ نَكْتَةً سَوْدَاءُ فَإِذَا هُوَ نَزَعَ وَاسْتَغْفَرَ وَتَابَ صَقِلَ قَلْبُهُ
وَإِنْ عَادَ زِيدَ فِيهَا حَتَّى تَعْلُوَ قَلْبُهُ وَهُوَ الرَّانُ الَّذِي ذَكَرَ اللَّهُ : (
كَلَّا بَلْ رَانَ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ مَا كَانُوا يَكْسِبُونَ) ".³

¹ أخرجه مسلم (2654) من حديث عبد الله بن عمرو بن العاص رضي الله عنه.

² أخرجه مسلم (2702) من حديث الأغر المزني رضي الله عنه.

³ إسناده حسن.

6- Seeking refuge from heart that does not entertain the fear (of Allah):

The Prophet (ﷺ) used to say in his supplication: **“O Allah, I seek refuge in Thee from the knowledge which does not benefit, from the heart that does not entertain the fear (of Allah), from the soul that does not feel contented and the supplication that is not responded.”**¹

The Prophet (ﷺ) used to teach some of his companions to seek refuge from evil of his heart, saying, **“O God, I seek refuge in Thee from evil in what I hear, see, speak, think about, and from evil arising from my sexual passion.”**²

6- Attending the assemblies held for remembrance of Allah and exhortations with the righteous:

The assemblies held for remembrance of Allah and exhortations soften the heart as Al-Irbad Ibn Sarya said: “One day the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) led us in prayer, then faced us and gave us a lengthy exhortation at which the eyes shed tears and the hearts were afraid. A man said: Messenger of Allah! It seems as if it were a farewell exhortation, so what injunction do you give us?”

He then said: **“I enjoin you to fear Allah, and to hear and obey even if it be an Abyssinian slave, for those of you who live after me will see great disagreement. You must then follow my sunnah**

¹ Sahih Muslim 2722 from hadith of Zayd Ibn Al-Arqam

² Nasa’i, with sahih grade (8/ 255, 256, 259, 260) from Hadith of Shaki Ibn Hameed

6- الاستِعاذة من قلب لا يخشع:

فقد كَانَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ فِي دُعَائِهِ: "اللَّهُمَّ إِنِّي أَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْ عِلْمٍ لَا يَنْفَعُ وَمِنْ قَلْبٍ لَا يَخْشَعُ وَمِنْ نَفْسٍ لَا تَشْبَعُ وَمِنْ دَعْوَةٍ لَا يُسْتَجَابُ لَهَا"¹

وَكَانَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يُعَلِّمُ بَعْضَ أَصْحَابِهِ أَنْ يَتَعَوَّذَ مِنْ شَرِّ قَلْبِهِ فَيَقُولُ "قُلِ: اللَّهُمَّ إِنِّي أَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْ شَرِّ سَمْعِي وَبَصَرِي وَلِسَانِي وَقَلْبِي وَمَنِيِّ".²

7- حُضُور مَجَالِسِ الذِّكْرِ وَالْمَوَاعِظِ وَرُؤْيَا الصَّالِحِينَ وَمُجَالَسَتِهِمْ:

فَإِنَّ مَجَالِسَ الذِّكْرِ تُرَقِّقُ الْقُلُوبَ كَمَا قَالَ فَقَالَ الْعِرْبَاضُ بْنُ سَارِيَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ: صَلَّى بِنَا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ ذَاتَ يَوْمٍ ثُمَّ أَقْبَلَ عَلَيْنَا فَوَعَّظَنَا مَوْعِظَةً بَلِيغَةً ذَرَفَتْ مِنْهَا الْعُيُونُ وَوَجِلَتْ مِنْهَا الْقُلُوبُ فَقَالَ قَائِلٌ يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ كَأَنَّ هَذِهِ مَوْعِظَةٌ مُودَّعٌ فَمَاذَا تَعْهَدُ إِلَيْنَا؟

فَقَالَ " أَوْصِيكُمْ بِتَقْوَى اللَّهِ وَالسَّمْعِ وَالطَّاعَةِ وَإِنْ عَبْدًا حَبَشِيًّا فَإِنَّهُ مَنْ يَعِشْ مِنْكُمْ بَعْدِي فَسِيرَى اخْتِلَافًا كَثِيرًا فَعَلَيْكُمْ بِسُنَّتِي

¹ أخرجه مسلم (2722) من حديث زيد بن أرقم رضي الله عنه.

² أخرجه النسائي بسند صحيح (8/ 255، 256، 259، 260) من حديث شكل بن حميد رضي الله عنه

and that of the rightly-guided caliphs. Hold to it and stick fast to it. Avoid novelties, for every novelty is an innovation, and every innovation is an error.”¹

The assemblies held for remembrance of Allah has also an effect on remedy of the hearts and removing misery as the hadith of Sahih al-Bukhari (6408) Abu Huraira narrated that Allah 's Apostle (ﷺ) said, **"Allah has some angels who look for those who celebrate the Praises of Allah on the roads and paths. And when they find some people celebrating the Praises of Allah, they call each other, saying, "Come to the object of your pursuit." "**

He added, "Then the angels encircle them with their wings up to the sky of the world."

He added. "(after those people celebrated the Praises of Allah, and the angels go back), their Lord, asks them (those angels) - though He knows better than them- 'What do My slaves say?'

The angels reply, 'They say: Subhan Allah, Allahu Akbar, and Alham-du-li I-lah,

Allah then says 'Did they see Me?'

The angels reply, 'No! By Allah, they didn't see You.'

Allah says, How it would have been if they saw Me?'

The angels reply, 'If they saw You, they would worship You more devoutly, celebrate Your Glory more deeply, and declare Your freedom from any resemblance to anything more often.'

Allah says (to the angels), 'What do they ask Me for?'

¹ Sunan Abi Dawud 4607

وَسُنَّةِ الْخُلَفَاءِ الْمَهْدِيِّينَ الرَّاشِدِينَ تَمَسَّكُوا بِهَا وَعَضُّوا عَلَيْهَا
بِالنَّوَاجِدِ وَإِيَّاكُمْ وَمُحَدَّثَاتِ الْأُمُورِ فَإِنَّ كُلَّ مُحَدَّثَةٍ بِدْعَةٍ وَكُلَّ
بِدْعَةٍ ضَلَالَةٌ¹.

وَكَذَلِكَ فَإِنَّ لِمَجَالِسِ الذِّكْرِ تَأْثِيرًا فِي صِلَاحِ الْقُلُوبِ وَرَفْعِ
الشَّقَاءِ، فَقَدْ أَخْرَجَ الْبُخَارِيُّ (6408) مِنْ حَدِيثِ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ
اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " إِنَّ لِلَّهِ
مَلَائِكَةً يَطُوفُونَ فِي الطُّرُقِ، يَلْتَمِسُونَ أَهْلَ الذِّكْرِ، فَإِذَا وَجَدُوا
قَوْمًا يَذْكُرُونَ اللَّهَ تَنَادَوْا هَلُمُّوا إِلَى حَاجَتِكُمْ.

قَالَ: فَيُحْفُونَهُمْ بِأَجْنَحَتِهِمْ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ الدُّنْيَا.

قَالَ: فَيَسْأَلُهُمْ رَبُّهُمْ وَهُوَ أَعْلَمُ مِنْهُمْ مَا يَقُولُ عِبَادِي؟

قَالُوا: يَقُولُونَ يُسَبِّحُونَكَ، وَيُكَبِّرُونَكَ، وَيَحْمَدُونَكَ
وَيُمَجِّدُونَكَ.

قَالَ: فَيَقُولُ هَلْ رَأَوْنِي؟

قَالَ: فَيَقُولُونَ لَا وَاللَّهِ مَا رَأَوْكَ.

قَالَ: فَيَقُولُ: وَكَيْفَ لَوْ رَأَوْنِي؟

قَالَ: يَقُولُونَ: لَوْ رَأَوْكَ كَانُوا أَشَدَّ لَكَ عِبَادَةً، وَأَشَدَّ لَكَ
تَمَجِيدًا، وَأَكْثَرَ لَكَ تَسْبِيحًا.

قَالَ: يَقُولُ: فَمَا يَسْأَلُونِي؟

¹ أخرجه أبو داود (4607)

The angels reply, 'They ask You for Paradise.'

Allah says (to the angels), 'Did they see it?'

The angels say, 'No! By Allah, O Lord! They did not see it.'

Allah says, 'How it would have been if they saw it?'

The angels say, 'If they saw it, they would have greater covetousness for it and would seek It with greater zeal and would have greater desire for it.'

Allah says, 'From what do they seek refuge?'

The angels reply, 'They seek refuge from the (Hell) Fire.'

Allah says, 'Did they see it?'

The angels say, 'No By Allah, O Lord! They did not see it.'

Allah says, 'How it would have been if they saw it?'

The angels say, 'If they saw it they would flee from it with the extreme fleeing and would have extreme fear from it.'

Then Allah says, 'I make you witnesses that I have forgiven them.'"

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) added, "One of the angels would say, 'There was so-and-so amongst them, and he was not one of them, but he had just come for some need.'

Allah would say, 'These are those people whose companions will not be reduced to misery.' "

قَالَ: يَسْأَلُونَكَ الْجَنَّةَ.

قَالَ: يَقُولُ: وَهَلْ رَأَوْهَا؟

قَالَ: يَقُولُونَ: لَا وَاللَّهِ يَا رَبِّ مَا رَأَوْهَا؟

قَالَ: يَقُولُ: فَكَيْفَ لَوْ أَنَّهُمْ رَأَوْهَا؟

قَالَ: يَقُولُونَ: لَوْ أَنَّهُمْ رَأَوْهَا كَانُوا أَشَدَّ عَلَيْهَا حِرْصًا، وَأَشَدَّ لَهَا طَلَبًا، وَأَعْظَمَ فِيهَا رَغْبَةً.

قَالَ: فَمِمَّ يَتَعَوَّذُونَ؟

قَالَ: يَقُولُونَ: مِنَ النَّارِ.

قَالَ: يَقُولُ: وَهَلْ رَأَوْهَا؟

قَالَ: يَقُولُونَ: لَا وَاللَّهِ مَا رَأَوْهَا.

قَالَ: يَقُولُ: فَكَيْفَ لَوْ رَأَوْهَا؟

قَالَ: يَقُولُونَ: لَوْ رَأَوْهَا كَانُوا أَشَدَّ مِنْهَا فِرَارًا، وَأَشَدَّ لَهَا مَخَافَةً.

قَالَ فَيَقُولُ: فَأُشْهِدُكُمْ أَنِّي قَدْ غَفَرْتُ لَهُمْ.

قَالَ: يَقُولُ مَلَكٌ مِنَ الْمَلَائِكَةِ: فِيهِمْ فَلَانٌ لَيْسَ مِنْهُمْ، إِنَّمَا جَاءَ لِحَاجَةٍ.

قَالَ: هُمْ الْجُلَسَاءُ لَا يَشْقَى بِهِمْ جَلِيسُهُمْ."

And hadith of Sahih Muslim (2750) Hanzala Usayyidi reported: I met Abu Bakr. He said: Who are you?

He (Hanzala) said: Hanzala has turned to be a hypocrite.

He (Abu Bakr) said: Hallowed be Allah, what are you saying?

Thereupon he said: I say that when we are in the company of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) we ponder over Hell-Fire and Paradise as if we are seeing them with our very eyes and when we are away from Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) we attend to our wives, our children, our business; most of these things (pertaining to After-life) slip out of our minds.

Abu Bakr said: By Allah, I also experience the same.

So, I and Abu Bakr went to Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) and said to him: Allah's Messenger, Hanzala has turned to be a hypocrite.

Thereupon Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: What has happened to you?

I said: Allah's Messenger, when we are in your company, we are reminded of Hell-Fire and Paradise as if we are seeing them with our own eyes, but whenever we go away from you and attend to our wives, children and business, much of these things go out of our minds.

Thereupon Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: By Him in Whose Hand is my life, if your state of mind remains the same as it is in my presence and you are always busy in remembrance (of Allah),

وَأُخْرِجَ مُسْلِمٌ (2750) مِنْ حَدِيثِ حَنْظَلَةَ الْأَسَيْدِيِّ، قَالَ -
لَقِينِي أَبُو بَكْرٍ فَقَالَ: كَيْفَ أَنْتَ يَا حَنْظَلَةُ؟
قَالَ: قُلْتُ: نَافَقَ حَنْظَلَةُ.

قَالَ: سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ مَا تَقُولُ؟

قَالَ: قُلْتُ: نَكُونُ عِنْدَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ
يُذَكِّرُنَا بِالنَّارِ وَالْجَنَّةِ حَتَّى كَأَنَّ رَأْيَ عَيْنٍ فَإِذَا خَرَجْنَا مِنْ عِنْدِ
رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ عَافَسْنَا الْأَزْوَاجَ وَالْأَوْلَادَ
وَالضَّيْعَاتِ فَنَسِينَا كَثِيرًا.

قَالَ أَبُو بَكْرٍ. فَوَاللَّهِ إِنَّا لَنَلْقَى مِثْلَ هَذَا.

فَانْطَلَقْتُ أَنَا وَأَبُو بَكْرٍ حَتَّى دَخَلْنَا عَلَى رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ
عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ.

قُلْتُ: نَافَقَ حَنْظَلَةُ يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ.

فَقَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " وَمَا ذَاكَ؟ "

قُلْتُ: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ نَكُونُ عِنْدَكَ، تُذَكِّرُنَا بِالنَّارِ وَالْجَنَّةِ، حَتَّى
كَأَنَّ رَأْيَ عَيْنٍ فَإِذَا خَرَجْنَا مِنْ عِنْدِكَ، عَافَسْنَا الْأَزْوَاجَ وَالْأَوْلَادَ
وَالضَّيْعَاتِ نَسِينَا كَثِيرًا.

فَقَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: " وَالَّذِي نَفْسِي بِيَدِهِ
إِنْ لَوْ تَدُومُونَ عَلَى مَا تَكُونُونَ عِنْدِي وَفِي الذِّكْرِ

the Angels will shake hands with you in your beds and in your paths but, Hanzala, time should be devoted (to the worldly affairs) and time (should be devoted to prayer and meditation). He (the Prophet) said this thrice.

8- Repelling suspicions from the believers so that their hearts may be purified and their souls pure:

In the Hadith of Sahih al-Bukhari (2035), Safiya bint Huyai, the mother of the believers, narrated that **she went to Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) to visit him in the mosque while he was in I'tikaf in the last ten days of Ramadan. She had a talk with him for a while, then she got up in order to return home. The Prophet (ﷺ) accompanied her.**

When they reached the gate of the mosque, opposite the door of Um-Salama, two Ansari men were passing by, and they greeted Allah's Apostle.

He told them: Do not run away! And said, "She is (my wife) Safiya bint Huyai."

Both of them said, "Subhan Allah, (How dare we think of any evil) O Allah's Messenger (ﷺ)!" And they felt it.

The Prophet said (to them), "Satan reaches everywhere in the human body as blood reaches in it, I was afraid lest Satan might insert an evil thought in your minds."

9- Staying away from the places of temptation:

Allah Almighty said: **"when you ask [his wives] for something, ask them from behind a partition. That is purer for your hearts and their hearts."** (Al-Ahzab: 53)

لَصَافَحْتَكُمْ الْمَلَائِكَةَ عَلَى فُرُشِكُمْ وَفِي طُرُقِكُمْ وَلَكِنْ يَا حَنْظَلَةَ سَاعَةً وَسَاعَةً " . ثَلَاثَ مَرَّاتٍ .

8- دَفَعَ الشُّبُهَاتِ عَنِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ حَتَّى تَظْهَرَ قُلُوبُهُمْ وَتَزْكُو نَفُوسُهُمْ:

فَقَدْ أَخْرَجَ الْبُخَارِيُّ (2035) مِنْ حَدِيثِ أُمِّ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ صَفِيَّةَ بِنْتُ حُجٍّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا قَالَتْ: أَنَّهَا جَاءَتْ إِلَى رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ تَزُورُهُ فِي اعْتِكَافِهِ فِي الْمَسْجِدِ، فِي الْعَشْرِ الْآخِرِ مِنْ رَمَضَانَ، فَتَحَدَّثَتْ عِنْدَهُ سَاعَةً، ثُمَّ قَامَتْ تَنْقَلِبُ، فَقَامَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مَعَهَا يَقْلِبُهَا،

حَتَّى إِذَا بَلَغَتْ بَابَ الْمَسْجِدِ عِنْدَ بَابِ أُمِّ سَلَمَةَ مَرَّ رَجُلَانِ مِنَ الْأَنْصَارِ، فَسَلَّمَا عَلَى رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ

فَقَالَ لَهُمَا النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " عَلَى رِسَالِكُمَا إِنَّمَا هِيَ صَفِيَّةُ بِنْتُ حُجٍّ " .

فَقَالَا سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ . وَكَبَّرَ عَلَيْهِمَا .

فَقَالَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " إِنَّ الشَّيْطَانَ يَبْلُغُ مِنَ الْإِنْسَانِ مَبْلَغَ الدَّمِ، وَإِنِّي خَشِيتُ أَنْ يَقْذِفَ فِي قُلُوبِكُمَا شَيْئًا "

9- الْبُعْدُ عَنِ مَوَاطِنِ الْفِتَنِ:

قَالَ اللَّهُ عَزَّوَجَلَّ: "وَإِذَا سَأَلْتُمُوهُنَّ مَتَاعًا فَسْأَلُوهُنَّ مِنْ وَرَاءِ حِجَابٍ ۚ ذَلِكُمْ أَطْهَرُ لِقُلُوبِكُمْ وَقُلُوبِهِنَّ" (الأحزاب: 53)

10- Littleness of laughing:

As too much laughing kills the heart.

11- Visiting the graves and contemplating upon the state of its people and their final destination:

In Sahih Muslim and others,¹ It was narrated from Abu Hurairah that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said: **“Visit the graves, for they will remind you of the Hereafter.”**

12- Contemplating about the lands of those destroyed by Allah and taking lessons from the dwellings of the people of old:

If 'Abdullah b. 'Umar wanted to care for his heart, he would go to the ruins and stand at its door. He would then call out with a sad voice, 'Where is your occupants?' Then he would say to himself: **“Everything will be destroyed except His Face.”** (Al-Qasas: 88)²

13- And among them:

- Eating that which is lawful
- Benevolence to the orphans and poor
- The remembrance of death

And many other reasons which help to remove the hardness of the heart.

¹ Sahih Muslim (976) (106)

² Hasan, narrated by ibn El-Mubarak in Az-Zuhd (p.144) (639)

10- قِلَّةُ الضَّحِكِ: فَإِنَّ كَثْرَةَ الضَّحِكِ تُمِيتِ الْقُلُوبَ.

11- زِيَارَةُ الْقُبُورِ بِالتَّفَكُّرِ فِي حَالِ أَهْلِهَا وَمَصِيرِهِمْ:

وقد ثبت في صحيح مسلم وغيره ¹ عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، عَنِ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ "زُورُوا الْقُبُورَ فَإِنَّهَا تَذَكِّرُكُمُ الْآخِرَةَ".

12- النَّظَرُ فِي دِيَارِ الْهَالِكِينَ، وَالْأَعْتِبَارُ بِمَنَازِلِ الْغَابِرِينَ:

وَكَانَ ابْنُ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ إِذَا أَرَادَ أَنْ يَتَعَاهدَ قَلْبَهُ يَأْتِي الْخُرْبَةَ فَيَقِفُ عَلَيَّ بَابِهَا، فَيُنَادِي بِصَوْتِ حَزِينٍ، فَيَقُولُ: أَيْنَ أَهْلُكَ؟ ثُمَّ يَرْجِعُ إِلَى نَفْسِهِ، فَيَقُولُ: "كُلُّ شَيْءٍ هَالِكٌ إِلَّا وَجْهَهُ" (القصص: 88)²

13- وَمِنْهَا:

- أَكْلُ الْحَلَالِ.

- وَالْإِحْسَانُ إِلَى الْيَتَامَى وَالْمَسَاكِينِ.

- وَذِكْرُ الْمَوْتِ.

وغيرها من الأسباب الكثيرة التي تُسَاعِدُ عَلَى إِزَالَةِ قَسْوَةِ الْقَلْبِ.

¹ أخرجه مسلم (976) (106)

² إسناده حسن: أخرجه ابن المبارك في الزهد (ص 144) (639)

May Allah clean away all forms of evil from our hearts and the hearts of Muslims.

May Allah make us among those who come toward Him with a sound and very penitent heart turned in devotion to Him.

May Allah lighten our hearts and the hearts of Muslims, our hearings and our sights.

May Allah make us among those **“Who listen to speech and follow the best of it. Those are the ones Allāh has guided, and those are people of understanding”** (Az-zumar 18)

ظَهَرَ اللَّهُ قُلُوبَنَا وَقُلُوبَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ مِنْ كُلِّ مَكْرُوهٍ وَسُوءٍ.
وَجَعَلَنَا اللَّهُ مِنَ الْمُقْبِلِينَ عَلَيْهِ بِقَلْبٍ سَلِيمٍ أَوَّاهٍ مُنِيبٍ.
وَأَنَارَ اللَّهُ قُلُوبَنَا وَالْمُسْلِمِينَ وَأَسْمَاعِنَا وَأَبْصَارِنَا.

وَجَعَلَنَا اللَّهُ مِنْ **"الَّذِينَ يَسْتَمِعُونَ الْقَوْلَ فَيَتَّبِعُونَ أَحْسَنَهُ"**
أُولَئِكَ الَّذِينَ هَدَاهُمُ اللَّهُ وَأُولَئِكَ هُمْ أُولُوا الْأَلْبَابِ" (الزمر:

(18)

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